

Origen's treatment of Matt. 19:19 is significant in two other ways. First he was probably the most influential commentator of the Ancient Church and yet his conjecture at this point seems to have influenced only one manuscript of a local version of the New Testament. The Greek tradition is apparently quite unaffected by it. From the third century onward even an Origen could not effectively alter the text.

This brings us to the second significant point—his date. From the early third century onward the freedom to alter the text which had obtained earlier can no longer be practiced. Tatian is the last author to make deliberate changes in the text of whom we have explicit information. Between Tatian and Origen Christian opinion had so changed that it was no longer possible to make changes in the text whether they were harmless or not.¹

The point made by Kilpatrick seems to me to be obvious. Evidently there would be occasional exceptions, especially in remote areas like Egypt where Greek was no longer spoken. After Diocletian's campaign [303] most monks simply copied what was in front of them. Most of the 45 lines of transmission mentioned above probably already existed in the year 300.)

1 Peter

As I did with James, I take note of what John William Burgon called the *concordia discors*, the prevailing confusion and disagreement, which the early uncials (ΣABCD—he personally collated each) display between/among themselves.

Concordia discors

Four of those uncials are extant in 1 Peter (ΣABC), to which I add P⁷² (which wasn't extant in Burgon's day), and what Burgon calls their 'eccentric tendency' is plainly visible. That eccentricity establishes their independence, which is of special interest in what follows. I proceed to tabulate their performance in the 141 relevant variant sets (disregarding the 13 with *rell*) included in the critical apparatus of my edition of the Greek Text of 1 Peter. I do so using f³⁵ as the point of reference:

¹ G.D. Kilpatrick, "Atticism and the Text of the Greek New Testament," *Neutestamentliche Aufsätze* (Regensburg: Verlag Friedrich Pustet, 1963), pp. 129-30.